

Vanteloq Data Retention and Disposal Policy

DRAFT FOR APPROVAL

Owner signature is required before this policy is represented as adopted or uploaded to Plaid.

Document control	Value
Organization	LexEdge Consulting, operating Vanteloq
Policy owner	Hussien Issa, Owner and Security Lead
Version	1.0
Prepared	2026-08-13
Review cycle	Quarterly enforcement review; full annual review
Approval status	Awaiting owner approval

1. Purpose and scope

This policy defines how Vanteloq retains, reviews, deletes, de-identifies, and disposes of consumer, financial, business, authentication, integration, and security data. It applies to production databases, object storage, logs, backups, exports, support systems, connected providers including Plaid, and local copies created for an authorized business purpose.

Vanteloq retains data only while it is needed for a disclosed product purpose, security, legal obligation, dispute, or documented business requirement. Retention is not indefinite by default.

2. Roles

- The Owner and Security Lead approves the schedule, exceptions, legal holds, and deletion evidence.
- System owners implement retention controls in each service and verify their operation.
- Authorized users may request disconnection or deletion through the product or support channel.
- Service providers must be configured or instructed to delete data consistently with this policy and applicable contracts.

3. Retention schedule

Data category	Default active retention	Disposal trigger and method
Plaid access tokens and item identifiers	While the connection is active and authorized	Revoke provider access and cryptographically delete the encrypted credential when disconnected, authorization is withdrawn, or deletion is approved
Plaid account balances and transaction records	While the connected feature is active; reviewed after 24 months without authorized use	Delete source and derived financial records on verified deletion, subject to a documented legal hold
Plaid Link consent and authorization evidence	Connection life plus 6 years	Delete or de-identify after expiry unless law or dispute requires continued retention
POS, inventory, customer, supplier, and commerce records	Active service plus up to 7 years where required for accounting, tax, or audit support	Delete or de-identify after account closure and the applicable legal period
Invoices, receipts, journal support, and tax records	7 years unless a longer legal requirement applies	Securely delete after expiry and hold review
Authentication and membership records	Active account plus 2 years	Delete or de-identify after account closure, except security evidence under hold
Security and administrative audit events	2 years	Securely delete after expiry and incident/hold review
Application and request logs	90 days by default	Automated expiry; restricted incident copies follow the incident record period
Support records	2 years after closure	Delete or de-identify after expiry and dispute review
Temporary exports and generated files	30 days or shorter when no longer needed	Automated expiry or immediate secure deletion after delivery
Failed or abandoned uploads	24 hours	Automatic purge from quarantine and temporary storage

Where another law, contract, or provider rule requires a different period, Vanteloq records the applicable source, category, period, and owner in the retention register.

4. Consumer consent and purpose limitation

Before Plaid Link is initiated, Vanteloq displays the data categories, purposes, policy versions, and deletion route, and records affirmative consent. Only the products and data needed for the selected use are requested. Expanding the purpose or data category requires new or updated authorization.

Withdrawing consent stops future collection that relies on consent. It does not override a documented legal obligation, but any retained record must be limited to that obligation and unavailable for unrelated product use.

5. Deletion and disconnection procedure

Plaid deletion is a protected owner action requiring a current authenticated AAL2 session, tenant and finance authorization, a fresh deletion confirmation, and a rate-limited server request. The deletion process must:

- 1 identify the organization, connection, source accounts, raw financial records, derived records, reports, and audit scope;
- 2 revoke or remove the Plaid item when provider credentials are available;
- 3 delete encrypted Plaid credentials and account data;
- 4 delete transactions, balances, derived cash metrics, sync cursors, and unauthorized exports tied to the connection;
- 5 de-identify only the minimal audit evidence required to prove the deletion occurred;
- 6 invalidate cached or generated views; and
- 7 record the request, authorization, scope, result, and timestamp without retaining the deleted secret.

If provider revocation cannot complete, Vanteloq must fail closed, retain the request for controlled retry, block further use of the connection, and notify the authorized requester without exposing a credential.

6. Account closure and inactivity

Account closure starts a documented deletion workflow after billing, dispute, legal-hold, and export obligations are checked. Connected providers are disconnected and recurring synchronization stops. Inactive connections are reviewed at least quarterly; a connection that no longer has a valid purpose or authorization is disabled and scheduled for deletion.

7. Backups, caches, and derived data

Deletion applies to primary records, caches, search indexes, generated reports, exports, and derived analytics. Where a provider-managed immutable backup cannot be selectively edited, the deleted record must remain inaccessible to normal operations and expire through the provider's documented backup lifecycle. A restored backup must reapply all deletion tombstones before returning to service.

8. Legal holds and exceptions

Only the Owner and Security Lead may approve a legal hold or retention exception. The record must name the data, reason, authority, owner, start date, review date, and release condition. Held data is restricted to the hold purpose. When the hold ends, normal disposal resumes promptly.

9. Disposal standards

- Database and object records are deleted through authenticated server-side operations.
- Encryption keys or wrapped credentials are destroyed when cryptographic deletion is used.
- Physical media, if ever used, is destroyed through a documented secure-media process.
- Paper records containing restricted data are cross-cut shredded.
- Service-provider deletion or contract termination is recorded.
- Disposal logs identify scope and outcome without reproducing sensitive content.

10. Review, testing, and evidence

The retention schedule and enforcement status are reviewed quarterly and after a material product, provider, legal, or data-use change. The full policy is reviewed annually. Reviews must verify configured TTLs, deletion queues, provider disconnection, backup treatment, stale exports, legal holds, and a sample end-to-end deletion.

Evidence includes consent records, deletion audit events, provider revocation results, retention-job logs, exception approvals, legal-hold records, and signed review minutes. A control is not reported as operational until dated evidence exists.

This policy takes effect only when the owner completes the approval record. The first quarterly enforcement review is due within 90 days of approval.

Approval

Field	Entry
Approved by	_____
Title	Owner and Security Lead
Approval date	_____
Signature	_____
Next annual review	_____